

The media attention that's come post the win might help push all this along."

All about the inside

Time away from the main stage has also prompted a rethink of how she interacts with spaces like social media.

The blog has not been updated since 2021, something Shikha intends to change, but other networking apps have taught her a certain indifference that mirrors how she deals with naysayers in real life.

"I remember in 2022, when I had a very good season, I put up videos. I did that for myself because I was really happy with my performance. Now you hear people say, if you're good, put your videos on social media so someone sees and gives you an opportunity. I am not saying it's a bad thing, but I am so glad we're at a place where that's not the only option. Franchise scouts are everywhere, watching everything."

The same social media has also told her to go back to the kitchen after a bad day in the field.

"It's nothing new. I have simply said once that I am heading back to



the kitchen to make dinner. The trolls haven't changed. My response to them has. Even recently, I am from UP. We are from Purvanchal, and we speak Bhojpuri. When I got into UP Warriorz, my mum had an

idea to write something in *Bhojpuri*, being the local team and all. Then came the comments questioning that choice, demanding a caption in Awadhi and stuff. I, in the past, would have restricted comments.

Who is the one person you would mute on the team WhatsApp group if you could?

Jemi! I don't know where she gets the energy from!

Pre-game superstition?

I do have a routine that I follow. If anything doesn't go to plan, I get fidgety. I prepare my own drinks. I have my diary. There's a whole list of things I need to do in a certain order.

One non-cricket thing in your kit bag?

For a long time, I used to carry a book in which I had noted down quotes from a lot of people. Things that kept me grounded. I also used to write four-liners in it. It was always in my kit bag, but I don't think I am carrying it now.

What is one skill you wish you could swap with a teammate?

Poker face. So many of them have it. If I am not happy about something, you'll see it on my face.

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